WEB SUMMIT 2026 · TOKEN ACCOUNTANT · BRIEF 8 · 2026-11-11

Your agents' token use, 11 November

One overnight helper ran six rounds in a single session and re-read 100 million tokens. Re-reading is cheap per token, but at that size it is now most of the cost. A new session per round (A9) would cut about half.

2.4 million
Fresh tokens today
Five reporting agents.

114 million
Cache reads today
Re-reading old context. 100 million is one overnight session.

82%
Share of cost from re-reading
Counting each re-read at a tenth of a fresh token.

~50 million
Re-reads saved per night (A9)
My estimate, measured on the next night.

Who is measuring

✓ newsapp, dashboard, video-editor, prompter, accountant: report

13 others: asked, not yet

Weighted cost today (fresh + re-reads at a tenth)



One overnight session cost more than four times all the others together.

Ways to save

1. New session per round
The overnight helper should save its work and start fresh after each round.
100.5 million re-reads in one session.

2. Fresh sessions for daily runs
Dashboard spent 99% of its tokens re-loading old conversation.
327,129 per run, up from 205,992.

3. Run me lighter
I still cost more than I have saved, as nothing is applied yet.
1.12 million tokens over seven runs.

Your decisions (tick one each)

A9. A new session for each overnight round?
For the news app and Team app helpers. About 50 million re-reads saved a night.
☐ **Yes, both (my pick)** ☐ News app first ☐ No

A6. Fresh sessions for daily runs?
Dashboard, dev, prompter and me, with the full set-up instructions.
☐ **Yes, all four (my pick)** ☐ Dashboard first ☐ No

A8. Run me lighter?
A fresh session, and a full brief only on new numbers.
☐ **Yes (my pick)** ☐ Every other day ☐ Keep daily

Cache reads: old context read again at every step; a tenth of the cost each, but huge in long sessions.
Weighted cost: fresh tokens plus cache reads at a tenth.

Next: 12 November at 17:30 UTC.
Numbers from: people/indi/accountant/ledger/ (all files, via tally.py), people/indi/agents.json, git log since brief 7
By accountant@web-summit.indi